



FLAT CHAT NEWSLETTER
AUSTIN-HEALEY OWNERS CLUB (NSW) INC
ABN: 87 630 303 136

VOL. 9 ISSUE #12
Dec 2022

COMING EVENTS

DECEMBER

- 1st Christmas Party/AGM
- 3rd Central Coast Christmas Drive
- 14th Committee Meeting

JANUARY

- 5th Monthly Meeting

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Purple Haze or Charlie's Run 2022

by Gordon Lynas

"Have we got everything?"

"I think so"

"Did you finish fixing the exhaust?"

"I did, can't you hear the difference?"

"Ooh, yes it does sound much nicer."

And with that Henrietta purred out of the drive and we headed for Gloucester. We were off on this year's Charlie's Run to Grafton and places in between. It was chilly, but sunny so we were well wrapped up and the heater was on. Just after Raymond Terrace we turned left onto Buckett's Way with a sense of relief leaving the busyness of the freeway behind for the quiet of the woods and farms. That was before the first scattering of potholes! At least there were a number of roadworks going on, but there was also a lot of other places where holes hadn't

yet been filled. So, the steering and my arms had a bit of a work out. Occasionally Louise would yell 'Look out!' followed by "Did you miss seeing that one? "We didn't exactly miss." (Shades of Winnie the Pooh, although it was Christopher Robin who 'didn't exactly miss.') At a more sedate pace we successfully navigated the worst sections and bumped our way north.

The Buckett's Way Motel has been refurbished since our last visit and is now very tidy and comfortable indeed. By 'beer o'clock' we had all arrived and after greetings, chatting and fore-gathering on the motel lawn, we strolled across to the Roundabout Inn for a communal dinner.

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Sue Cairns, Judy Sherman, Louise Lynas, Kay Britten, Muriel Roberts and Natalie Cessario enjoy a cuppa at Gloucester.



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WEB: www.austinhealeynsw.com.au

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Our monthly meetings are held at Strathfield Golf Club, 52 Weeroona Rd, Strathfield NSW 2135 on the 1st Thursday of each month commencing at 7.30pm.

Members and guests are welcome to join us for dinner in the bistro from 5.30pm.

PRESIDENT'S MESSAGE

This week is both the Christmas Party and the AGM and I'm hoping that we will have lots of lovely volunteers for committee positions. So if you'd like to help your club to be even better, the other committee members will give you a very warm welcome.

These two functions also mean that we are nearing the end of another year. Thankfully the Club's activities were not constrained by Covid this year, even though I did succumb in April. Saturday workshops on the Central Coast and in Sydney have been well attended enjoyable events. A big thank you to all of the workshop hosts without whom these could not happen. The Victorian AHOC finally managed to host its 'Mini-Rally' in May. Their determination was finally rewarded after three previous cancellations. A keen group of our members enjoyed a great long weekend in Mildura and for some of us, a leisurely cruise to Mildura via Jugiong, Beechworth, and Kerang as well.

We've had a number of weekend

functions starting with a run to Retford Park at Bowral, sometime home of James Fairfax amongst others and Fagan Park at Galston. We've got back into the swing of meeting at Strathfield Golf Club and I'm personally very pleased to note that the menu on offer has much improved since the first couple of meetings this year.

Charlie's Run happened earlier this month, journeying to Grafton for the Jacaranda Festival, largely thanks to Fay Bryant who got us interested in joining the unofficial Gold Coast Chapter of the Queensland AHOC who make this a fixture of their social calendar every year. With nine Austin-Healeys and a TR4 prominent in the Jacaranda Parade we were certainly very visible. On the way home we lunched at Pindimar at the invitation of the Tea Gardens and Hawks Nest Car Club. We were made very welcome beside the lake at the beautiful home of one of that club's members – a great way to end Charlie's Run. In fact, I'm thinking Charlie's Run could do a lot worse than to visit at least one local car club on each run.



Gordon Lynas – 0403 198 343 – gordonl@aussiebb.com.au

The AGM also means that some of our club's officers will retire, and new ones appointed, so I'd like to take this opportunity to thank each and every one of the outgoing committee for their efforts in reinvigorating the Club after the unfortunate, but very necessary Covid lockdowns.

Happy Healeying, and Happy Christmas. Gordon

COMMITTEE LIST - 2022

Club Patron—Ross Bond

President - Gordon Lynas
4 Wanari Road
Terrey Hills NSW 2084
0403 198 343
gordonl@aussiebb.com.au

Vice-President - Jim Phillips
0413 589 306
jpjimbeau@gmail.com

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Regalia - Colin Rule
0467 563 523
coolibahconvertible@bigpond.com

Technical Officer - Greg Strange
02 9319 2299
gregorymstrange@gmail.com

Club Registrar - Patrick Quinn
(Inc Conditional Registration)
Please send all Conditional Registration documents to Patrick's postal address at left

Public Relations - Ross Penman
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Webmaster - Jim Phillips
0413 589 306
jpjimbeau@gmail.com

Public Officer - Alan Mitchell
PO Box 123
Marulan 2579
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Non-Committee Positions
CSCA Delegate - Colin Goldsmith

Librarian - Ron Strange

CMC Delegates - Ray Roberts
Ian Clayton

Welfare Officer - Pamela Ross 0408 201 226

Display Day Coordinators - Ross & Jenny Penman

Conditional Registration Inspectors - Neville Stirtion
0414 472 877
Geoff Smith
0458 777 339

Assn of British Car Clubs Reps - Christine Lyttle

National Assn Delegates - Gordon Lynas & Jim Phillips

AHOC Life Members - Don Read, Joe Armour, Christine Lyttle, Patrick Quinn, Terry Bancroft, Ray Roberts and David Mould.

If you want to send something by post, the Club's address is:-

AHOC (NSW) Inc
PO Box 2754
North Parramatta NSW 1750

It would be appreciated if there were no phone calls to committee members after 9:00 PM.

EXHAUST LEAKS



By Patrick Quinn
(02) 4567 7380
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p_quinn@tpg.com.au

Greetings and welcome to the December 2022 issue of the *Flat Chat Newsletter*.

After my whinge of last month, it's only proper that I should write about the many AHOC members who took the trouble to write and reassure me that some people do in fact read the Flat Chat Newsletter. It's heartening to receive such warm comments and one member was kind enough to send me a card that really made my day. So yes Virginia, I can honestly say that there is a Santa Clause.

So what's in the December issue of the *Flat Chat Newsletter*? If

you have got this far you would see that on page 1 starts the report on the 2022 rendition of Charlie's Run. On page 9 you will find Colin and Kerrie Rule's words on the latest workshop gathering on the Central Coast. With 11 Austin-Healeys arriving on the day it's clear to see how popular these gatherings become.

Of course, the minutes starting on page 4 make for riveting reading and in all seriousness I suggest that you should read them so that you know what is happening within your club.

I am pleased to say that there are some thanks to be given to members who have contributed to this issue. Thanks to Ian Richter for his article on the origins of Petrol and thanks also to Ronnie Strange for another entertaining snippet from his long history of Austin-Healey ownership. Thanks as well to Harley Boggis for his photo contribution (see page 27) on the finish of the Perth to Sydney Marathon. Pleased also to receive photos from Richard Horwood on when he and Neville

Stirton stripped a recently acquired 100 engine.

As to the Quinn Austin-Healey, I never thought that I would be buying a set of new pistons, but I did. Bit of a mix up with the +40 pistons from AH Spares, as a set of +60 arrived by DHL. However, I am pleased to say that as soon as I let AH Spares know, the correct size pistons were on their way within hours. They duly arrived and the other set returned, all at no additional cost to the Quinn household.

I will finish up with wishing all members of the AHOC NSW and anyone else who reads this issue, a very merry Christmas from Caroline and myself.

Trust you enjoy this issue of the *Flat Chat Newsletter*.

There will be a January 2023 issue and hopefully full of interesting bits and pieces that will make for enjoyable post festive season reading.



Santa on the way to the AHOC Christmas party with a boot full of goodies for us all.

From Le Mans in 1953 and still my favourite Christmas Austin-Healey themed scene.

Monthly Meetings

We meet on the first Thursday of the month at Strathfield Golf Club Weeroona Rd, Strathfield. Starting at 7.30pm or enjoy dinner from 5.30pm



Minutes of the General Meeting

Thursday, 3 November 2022.

Commenced 7.40pm

Venue - Strathfield Golf Club

ATTENDEES

21 members attended

VISITORS & NEW MEMBERS

Nil

APOLOGIES

Patricia Bancroft, Mark & Gabi Bancroft, Vince Cessario, Jeff Burton, Dianne Lawlor, George & Liz Goodare, Gordon & Louise Lynas, Colin Rule, John & Judy Sherman, Neville Stirton, Greg Strange & Diane Lawlor.

APPROVAL OF MINUTES

Resolved that the minutes of the General Meeting held 6 October 2022, as published in the November 2022 issue of *Flat Chat*, be verified as a correct record of that meeting.

PRESIDENT'S REPORT

No Report

VICE-PRESIDENT'S REPORT

Jim reminded everyone about considering nominating for a Committee position at the upcoming AGM. He also provided an update on activities from the Central Coast, Mid-North Coast and Southern Highlands Chapters of the Club.

SECRETARY'S REPORT

Julie provided a brief update on emails of interest that had been received

TREASURER'S REPORT

In John's absence, Jim reported on the Club's funds as at 31 October 2022:

Debit card	\$11,968.82
Main Account	\$36,027.54
Cash Reserve	\$21,892.81
Charlie's Run	\$3,214.04
Term Deposit	\$70,000.00

As interest rates were now much better than in recent years, John had terminated the previous term depos-

it the Club had and then reinvested \$70,000 into a two-year TD at 4%.

SOCIAL SECRETARY'S REPORT

Jim, wearing another of his many hats for the evening, provided a brief report on social events, including the Christmas Party on Thursday, 1 December.

The Club had also been invited to the Terribly British Day car display, to be held 4 December at Queanbeyan Park lawns.

WELFARE OFFICER'S REPORT

Jim (again!) advised that Colin Rule was going in for an operation the following week, so Pamela would be sending a card on behalf of the Club.

WEBMASTER'S REPORT

Jim (for himself) displayed some statistics on website usage, noting that most seemed to be admin (i.e. himself), which was a bit disappointing. He encouraged members to check out the website to see what was there.

MEMBERSHIP

Jim reminded everyone about the 2023 National Rally, to be held at Chateau Elan in the Hunter Valley.

Julie reported that there were 21 attendees at the meeting, with two Austin-Healeys, one being the Richards' car from WA.

EDITOR'S REPORT

Patrick advised that Flat Chat had been sent out the previous evening. There'd been a few gremlins with sending it through the website, so it ended up being sent out three times.

Patrick then expressed his frustration that based on the questions received and comments heard, that it was clear that many members didn't read the Flat Chat Newsletter which given that it's the primary source of club information and the amount of work it entailed, was very disappointing.

REGISTRAR

On the subject of members not reading the magazine, Patrick advised that he'd had a couple of calls that day with questions on historic vehicle registration (HVR). He advised (yet again) that the process for renewing a car on HVR was in every issue of Flat Chat.

HISTORIAN

Given the Perth to Sydney Rally which was currently underway, (with former member Ashton Roskill and "Gidget" taking part), Joe's Healey history for the meeting was on historic car rallies. His story on John Sprinzel and a broken offside stub axle led to some debate on whether offside was the left or right hand side of the car! (JL: it's the driver's side of the car)

Joe also talked about the long history of cars which Donald Healey had designed, but which didn't bear the Healey name.

LIBRARIAN

Ronnie asked if anyone was interested in taking on the library, as he couldn't see that he could do much more with it, particularly with not attending meetings that often. Jim advised that the Committee was trying to find out from the Golf Club if there was somewhere to store the library on site.

TECHNICAL OFFICER/CLUB EQUIPMENT/SPARE PARTS

Jim showed a couple of photos from Geoff Smith's current projects – one was the new engine for Geoff's BJ8 and the other was the engine for Ken Offord's car.

PUBLIC RELATIONS REPORT

Ross didn't have any public relations news but he did mention how good Terry's Tassie trip had been!

CMC REPORT

No Report

ASSOCIATION OF BRITISH CAR CLUBS

No Report.

CSCA REPORT

No Report

REGALIA

Jim advised that Terry was going to be taking over as Regalia Officer while Colin was recuperating from his operation.

FOR SALE/WANTED

Amer was looking for some hinges for his BJ8.

SHOW or TELL

Terry's "tell" was to advise that his 1976 Triumph Bonneville motorcycle, which had been stolen from his house just before Christmas 2021, had been returned! Turned out it had been sitting at Mt Druitt Police Station since the day it was stolen but they'd only just connected the dots to contact Terry...

Patrick advised that he'd recently bought a set of pistons and, rather surprisingly, they were cheaper to buy from the UK than from South Australia.

Alan Mitchell's tale was on the number of UK detective shows which featured Austin-Healeys, including The Saint, The Invisible Man and Midsomer Murders as well as the US produced series The Twilight Zone

However Ronnie stole the "show" part of the meeting with a display of the paintings featured in his September Flat Chat article "Austin-Healeys on Canvas".

GENERAL BUSINESS

N/A

Meeting concluded at 8:50pm.





Sunday 4th December, 10am till 2pm 2022

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British Day**

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Merry Christmas

MEMBERSHIP REPORT – DECEMBER 2022

It's the time of the year for the Christmas spirit. Every year it appears to come around quicker than the year before! We hope that everyone can this year celebrate the Christmas spirit with their families and friends.

Payment for new members during November have been received and awaiting their membership forms for further details were:

John Kirk
Chris Jenkins
Kim Gillis

The Club will hold its annual Christmas Party and Annual General Meeting at the Strathfield Golf Club on Thursday 1 December 2022. By the time you read this, bookings will have closed for this event, and I am sure it will be another memorable night for the members in attendance.

This month the website was updated to align all details for members by our Webmaster, Jim Phillips, as with changes introduced by MYCCO it has updated our fields and often renamed some of them. Thanks, Jim, for your assistance with this task.

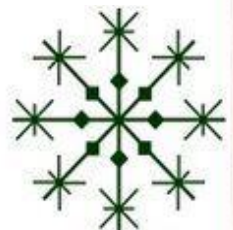
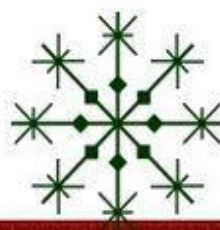
Don't forget to let me know if you change your address, email or any other details to ensure that we can keep your details as correct as possible, send any changes to membership@austinhealeynsw.com.au. Why not log in and check the website changes.

Keep safe and well during the holiday season!

Happy Healeying

Christine Lyttle

I wish everyone a very Happy Christmas and New Year and hope that we can meet at more social events during 2023.





Historic Vehicle Registration News

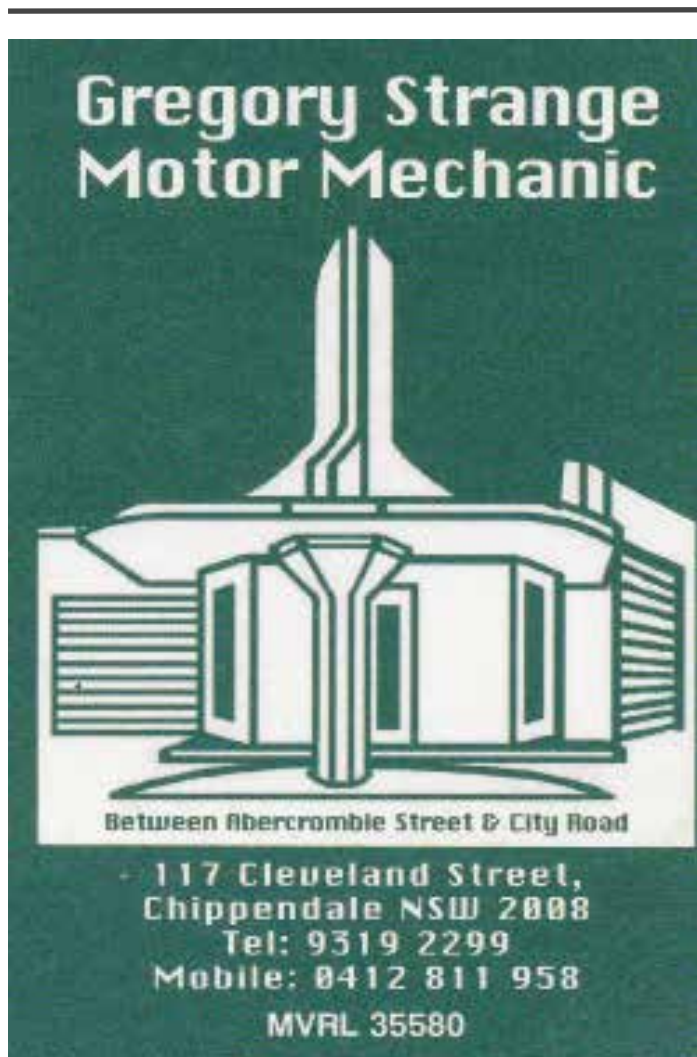
If you have a car on Historic Vehicle Registration you should read this.

It's not much is it? Just \$47 per annum so that you can use your conditionally registered vehicle for 60 days a year plus club events. Plus most insurers offer discounted rates for vehicles on Conditional Registration.

What's it cost to fully register your Austin-Healey or other older vehicle for 12 months including CTP insurance? Probably around \$450 to \$500 per annum. So Conditional Registration provides a considerable saving, and the restricted use of your vehicle is really hardly noticeable.

All of which makes me wonder why when members send their documents in for renewal, why they don't include a stamped return address envelope. That's the cost of a stamp plus the time to write the address on an envelope. All of \$1.10 plus five minutes. There are currently 223 cars conditionally registered through the AHOC and simple arithmetic tells me that's \$245.30 and 18.5 hours. That's time and money that frankly I don't want to spend.

In case you didn't know, some clubs actually charge for the processing of Conditional Registration, but the AHOC does not.



**Gregory Strange
Motor Mechanic**

Between Abercrombie Street & City Road

117 Cleveland Street,
Chippendale NSW 2008
Tel: 9319 2299
Mobile: 0412 811 958
MVRL 35580

The next time you renew your Conditional Registration don't forget the stamped addressed envelope.

"What do I do to renew my registration?" Is probably the most frequently asked question. Below are what steps to take place to renew your Conditional Registration.

- Once you have received the renewal from Transport for NSW, arrange for your vehicle to be inspected for roadworthiness by either an Authorised Inspection Station or one of the volunteer AHOC inspection officers. See page 2 of this *Flat Chat Newsletter* for their contact details. Remember all vehicles, including Historic vehicles need to be inspected and passed as roadworthy.
- Complete the left-hand side of the "Historic Vehicle Declaration" and post it to me at my home address (See page 2 of this *Flat Chat Newsletter* for my address) along with an indication that your car is roadworthy or a copy of the pink slip. Please include a stamped self-addressed envelope. There is no need to send me the registration certificate. Do not post me the documents by Registered Post as that just slows down the process as I have to go to the post office to accept a registered postal item.
- Once returned, either go to your local Services NSW office to do the renewal or post to Transport for NSW in Parkes. That address can be found on the registration papers.



Central Coast Workshop 5 November 2022

By Kerrie and Colin Rule

At last the weather has broken and we had a beautiful spring day for our Saturday morning Central Coast workshop held at Julie and Garry Lee's place at Niagara Park. Yes, a Big Thank You to Julie and Garry.

A brilliant turn up of Austin-Healeys 11 in fact, one racing Sunbeam Alpine and a KTM motorcycle with just a few Tin Tops. 20 participants all adding up to a fantastic morning with our traditional coffee, cookies and cake.

The main focus for the morning was to check out Garry's new shed and especially the car that was in the shed, a 1963 two-door 302 V8 Falcon coupe imported from the US and oh yes, very nice.

A big welcome to our first-time attendees, John Kirk from Jiliby, Richard Cardew from Terrigal with his Sunbeam Alpine and Kathleen and Kris Long from Cambridge Park with their BT7 Mk2 Roadster.

Names of the other attendees were, Geoff Smith MK1 3000, Jim Phillips 100/6, Ian and Jenni Richter, Harley Boggis KTM, Ross and Jenny Penman BJ8, Scott Parry-Jones 100/6, Mark McAllan BJ8, Lew McAllan BN7 Mk1, Kaye Parker, John Kirk Sprite MK 3, Doug Ross BJ7, hosts Julie and Garry Lee BJ8 and Kerrie with yours truly BN2.

The next Saturday morning Workshop will be our Christmas party drive to the scenic Yarramalong Valley for an early lunch at a nice little cafe called



Cont' next page

Workshop Cont'

Angel Sussurri. It's all happening on Saturday 3rd December.

The cafe is located on the corner of Yarramalong Road and Linga Longa Road Yarramalong. We can all meet at the old Somersby Hot Food and Cafe carpark, Wisemans Ferry Road, Somersby at 10 am and travel in convoy to the Cafe Angel Sussurri. For those folk coming from Sydney on the freeway, go past the Gosford turnoff and take the Peats Ridge Road on the left. Stay on Peats Ridge Road for ap-



prox. one km and then turn left into Wisemans Ferry Road.

The old cafe carpark is about 500metres from that corner on the right.

Our first meeting for 2023 will be Saturday 4th February at 109 Humphreys Road, Kincumber South.

So Happy Healeying folks, and all the best. Kerrie and Col Rule.



Merry Christmas
from
Colin & Kerrie Rule





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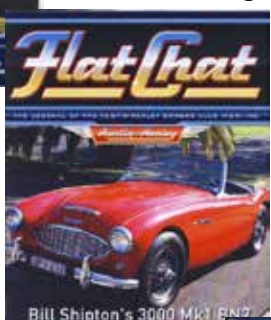
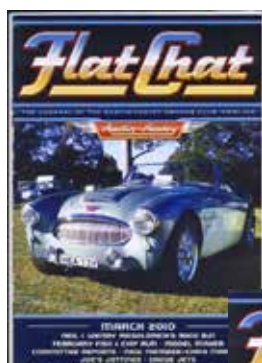
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Flat Chat Back Issues

Interested in receiving backcopies of Flat Chat?
Now available, digital copies of Flat Chat for 2005
through to December 2022.

That's 190+ issues for you to read at your leisure.
Free and gratis to members. All you have to do is send
a 1-3GB USB (thumb) drive to me at the below address
along with a stamped self-address envelope.



Patrick Quinn
"Wongaburra"
116 Warks Hill Road
Kurrajong Heights
NSW 2758

You can give me the drive (&
stamp) at a meeting.



Charlie's Run Cont'

Neville Stirton, Ian Roughley, Ray Roberts, Russell Kelly, Allan Whitehouse and John Thornton enjoying their version of a 'cuppa' after a hard drive.



The Sherman, Kelly and Lynas Austin-Healeys with the TR and the Kasza Westminster at Gloucester.



Thursday morning, we said goodbye to Susie and Denis Kasza and their 'Westminster' and spent a few minutes searching for the cause of the flood of water issuing from under Neville's borrowed TR4, before heading up Thunderbolt's Way for Walcha and Uralla. The road up the hill, always a good test for old cars was surprisingly in good condition and Henrietta performed faultlessly.



Louise Lynas looking for a map while Judy Sherman, Larry and Helen Johns and Joanne Hutton keep watch.

On we cruised. The road simply invited high speed running. It was a joy for a while, until sweeping round a corner revealed an extensive patch of road-pox. Hit the brakes! Twitch the steering. Jink between the worst holes and then magically the road would be good for another five or ten kms before the next poxy bit. "The countryside is looking really beautiful", opined Louise. I risked a look between poxed stretches and indeed it was, but it wasn't a day for letting the driver's gaze wander off the highway for too long without getting a rude awakening from the next pothole. We passed the road gang about 30kms out of Walcha and thought that they would be busy for months patching, filling, and rebuilding the road. From Walcha it was an easy run to Armidale and our next stop. The stream near our Motel showed evidence of recent flooding and road closures, so we were glad to have not been here a week or so earlier when getting to our destination each day could have been challenging. The TR was still with us, but its problems were accumulating, challenging Neville Stirton's skill in getting it ready for the next day's travel.

"What's the Waterfall Way like to Nymboida and Grafton?" we asked at the tourist office the next morning. "Oh, I wouldn't go that way, and whatever you do, avoid Nymboida as the road is in a really bad way after severe floods," was the reply. However, Vince Cessario wanted to see his old Sprite, which now lives at Bellingen, so he decided to would brave Waterfall Way. At least he would avoid Nymboida. The rest of us settled for the Gwydir Hwy from Glen Innes which proved to be an excellent choice. The Celtic Standing Stones made a fascinating and unusual stop for coffee. It's a bronze age style observatory like that at Callanish in Scotland, but doesn't have any lintels as at Stonehenge. Nevertheless, it's very impressive.



Celtic Standing Stones

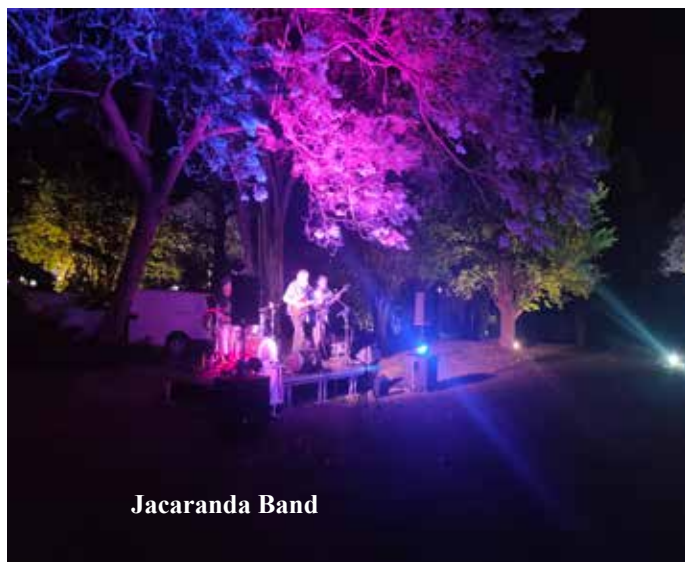
Charlie's Run Cont'

After that, we visited the Boundary Falls and the curiously named 'Raspberry Look Out' which gave fabulous views across ridge after ridge toward the ocean although I didn't see a single raspberry. Then it was down the hill to Grafton.



Raspberry Look Out

Friday evening, the Grafton Vintage Car Club (VGCC) had laid on a meeting with their members at the Village Inn. We sat on the balcony and enjoyed their company. Over the stream was a park where the Jacarandas were illuminated and later there was a band playing Rock and Roll which got a few people dancing the night away.



Jacaranda Band

Saturday was the Big Day for the Jacaranda Festival. It started with a 'Show and Shine' in the morning. Ten Austin-Healeys had pride of place in the centre of the display. Other cars included a very early Oldsmobile (replica?), Minis, Porsches, Holdens and Fords (of course), a Beetle, a Kombi and a Fiat 500 as well as a 1926 Studebaker, a Humber Super Snipe, Jaguar Mk2, a Sunbeam Talbot, Lotus Elan and Elise, and quite a few others all nicely arranged under beautiful Jacarandas. They might be flowering late in Sydney, but in Grafton they were superb.

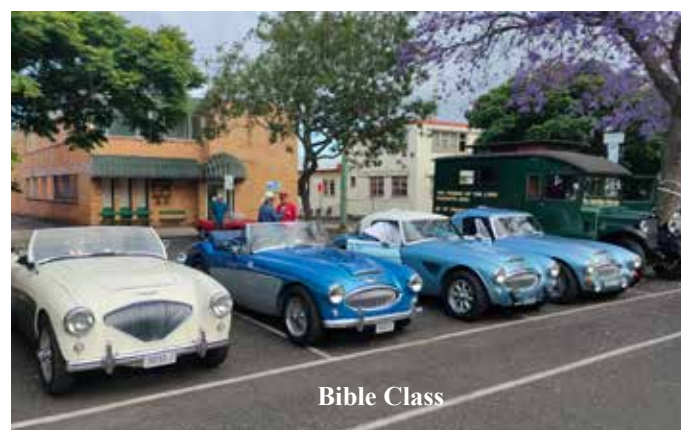


Louise Lynas, Joanne Hutton and Carole Kelly inspect Carole's hat while Allan Whitehouse wonders how a hat could be more interesting than a car display.



Ray Hick goes to find a coffee whilst the Hick, Cessario, and Joseph Austin-Healeys rest with the TR, a Torana and old Oldsmobile in front of another two 3000s.

Saturday afternoon was the big Parade, and I mean BIG. It must have stretched for over a couple of kilometres. Kim Dahl of GVCC had organised all the club events and had arranged for us to put our Austin-Healeys into the Parade and to have spare seats so we could drive some CWA veterans in the Parade. My companion was Irene Wells, a lovely lady from Glenreagh who wore a 1960's nurses cape and 'veil' and chatted happily and waved as we slowly paraded around Grafton for about 45 minutes. The kids were very enthusiastic about the Austin-Healeys encouraging Alan Whitehouse and to rev his engine to their loud cheers as we progressed. And then we were back at the Showground and Henrietta's 45 minutes of fame was over.



Bible Class

Charlie's Run Cont'

A fine variety of GVCC cars on display.



That evening the GVCC invited us to their club house for a pizza and trivia evening which went off very enjoyably and with much hilarity during the trivia questions. They even laid on a bus (at our cost) so that we didn't have to worry about drinking and driving.



Malcolm Larkin discussing the comfort of the rear seat of his 1926 Studebaker with Louise Lynas.

What a great set-up that Club has. Meeting room, kitchen, etc and a very well equipped workshop with heaps of tools – not one, but two car lifts, a wheel balancer and lots of other equipment that you wouldn't disgrace a commercial mechanic's or tyre workshop. If only ...

Sunday we were up early for a pleasant drive to

Yamba where we boarded the 'Iluka Ferry for a 'Lunch and Music Cruise' to Harwood and back. The duo providing the music soon had people dancing in the aisle – the conga was a particularly ambitious choice considering the space available, which of course provoked much commentary and laughter. The top deck was a sanctuary of peace and quiet in comparison to the main saloon and gave beautiful views of the river and surrounds.



Ray Hick and Fay Bryant enjoy a jive whilst Glenda Rabnott and Natalie Cessario enjoy closer dancing whilst John Sherman refuses to be tempted onto the floor.

The next day we said goodbye to Grafton. Some travelled by the Pacific Highway, other more adventurous souls took the Glenreagh and Nana Glen road. My friend Irene had warned against it, but as we wanted to see what had happened to the Glenreagh Tourist Railway the Shermans and the Lynas's took the adventurous route. Apart from a couple of bad bits the road was much better than we had expected, which was a considerable bonus. Sadly, the Glenreagh Tourist Railway seems to be fading away. Some 30 years ago it was running a steam train, 20 years ago a railcar, now? Apparently, nothing! Increased regulation, rising costs and diminishing volunteers seems to have drastically curtailed operations. But we did have a lovely drive along the Orara Way to Coffs.

At Port Macquarie we stayed once again at the El Paso Motel – star of several Charlie's Runs and other events – and ate at the 'Beach Club' overlooking the strand and the river.

The December meeting is scheduled for Thursday the 1st at Strathfield Golf Club Weeroona Rd, Strathfield. For this month it's our Christmas Party with the Annual General Meeting sandwiched in between courses.



A selection of the Tea Gardens Car Club's cars with the Lynas 100 ending the line.

Mike Latty, who is a member of both our Club and the Tea Gardens Car Club (TGCC), had seen that we were going to visit Tea Gardens on our way home. So, he arranged for TGCC to invite us for lunch. So, on Tuesday we pulled off the highway and onto Pindimar Road to Ranald Mackay's beautiful property where we found a great selection of cars gracing a hillside beside a lake in the manicured grounds of Ranald's home. We added our cars to the display and proceeded to enjoy a very warm welcome from the TGCC members present. There was much chatter strolling amongst the cars before we all sat for a delicious roast lunch and dessert. The sunny weather just completed the idyllic picture.



Tea Gardens and AHOC members chatting before lunch.

A leisurely dinner at the Country Club was followed by watching the 'blood moon' slowly develop before a good night's sleep. 'Purple Haze' was over bar the short journey home from Tea Gardens the following morning.

On behalf of all the Runners I'd like to sincerely thank the Grafton Vintage Car Club and the Tea Gardens Car Club for their hospitality and friendship and particularly Kim Dahl, Robyn and Ian Dunston of GVCC, and Mike Latty and Ranald Mackay of TGCC for their organisation of the events. We really enjoyed meeting those clubs and look forward to the next opportunity we might have to enjoy their company.



Larry Johns and John Sherman's Austin-Healeys end the line with a hot rod, 2CV, Minor, Merc', and Beetle, a Thunderbird in the background and elegant Fiat 124 Sport Coupé posing in the shade.



Unforgettable memories...



**Tuesday 2 May –
Friday 5 May 2023**



Chateau Elan

in the heart of the
famed Hunter Valley

Vintage Drive, Pokolbin NSW 2320

Nestled among rolling vineyards and
overlooking manicured fairways, breathtaking
scenery for its comprehensive offering, the
resort offers luxury hotel style accommodation

A Luxurious Holiday Experience in the Hunter Valley

16 Spa Treatment Rooms, Pool, Gym, Golf Course

Bookings direct to the Resort in advance



Bookings for the Resort must be made on the Chateau Elan's booking form
and sent with the payment direct to the Resort

Note Resort costs are not included in the ticket price of ~~\$500~~ \$440



Unforgettable memories..



RALLY NEWS

October 2022

Six months to go and many of you have now made your bookings for **HEALEYS IN THE HUNTER**. If you haven't yet booked your tickets and room, don't delay as they are filling up fast. We are well on our way to filling the 100 rooms at the beautiful Chateau Elan.

It's going to be a great Rally and just to whet your appetite, here is our [program of events](#).

Tuesday 2 May

Check in to [Chateau Elan](#) from 3pm and pick up your welcome pack at reception. At 7pm join everyone on the [Fairway Lawn](#) for Canapes and drinks.

Wednesday 3 May

Up early for a final polish, then drive your vehicle to the [Austin-Healey display](#) to view the other cars ([10am to 12 noon](#)). Enjoy [Hunter Valley Gardens](#) or browse the shops at [Pokolbin Village](#), taste some wine or vodka, or pick up a memento or two, or just stop for coffee and cake.

From 3pm to 5pm come and taste some [Hunter Valley wines and cheeses](#).



This evening is [Party Night!](#) Your 2 course dinner begins at 7pm in the [Founders Room](#), followed by as much dancing as anyone could want, or just enjoy chatting to friends old and new.

Thursday 4 May

This morning enjoy an organised country drive to either the historic [Hunter port town of Morpeth](#) or to picturesque [Wollombi](#). Or just enjoy some of the many delights of the Hunter Valley: [Maitland Art Gallery](#) is well worth a visit and has a great coffee shop; be wowed by the gorgeous views from the [Audrey Wilkinson winery's](#) hilltop location; or from the [Mt Bright lookout](#); or maybe book a [Go-Kart](#) session at nearby Kearsley and then test your putting prowess on the adjacent [Mount Panorama mini-golf](#). These and more are available for your enjoyment!

This evening is the [Gala Dinner](#). Once again we will congregate in the [Founders Room](#) for dinner to wrap up this Rally and to learn about the 2024's Rally.

Thursday is your opportunity for a round of Golf at the Vines or to be pampered at the Spa (early bookings essential for both).

Friday 5 May

Sadly, this morning it is time to pack our bags and say goodbye until next year. Join everyone for a [Farewell Brunch](#) in the restaurant (\$39 per person if you haven't included breakfasts with your room booking).

Why not book in a day early and enjoy the special accommodation rate being offered and enjoy the exclusive [Chateau Elan](#) and book a spa treatment or a round of golf?

Should you have any questions about the rally please do not hesitate to contact the committee via the designated email for the rally rally2023ahocnsw@hotmail.com and one of the rally committee will reply depending on your query.

That's it until 2023!

[Your Rally Committee](#)



THE AUSTIN-HEALEY 2023 NATIONAL RALLY

TUESDAY 2 MAY – FRIDAY 5 MAY 2023

REGISTRATION FORM

**REGISTRATIONS CLOSE ON
TUESDAY 31 JANUARY 2023**

unless numbers are at capacity and then you will be shortlisted

Rally Registrar:

Christine Lyttle

Email: rally2023ahocnsw@hotmail.com

Mail: PO Box 2754,

North Parramatta NSW 1750

Mobile: 0410 201 373

ADULTS ATTENDING

1.	2.
----	----

Regrettably no children to attend this event

YOUR PERSONAL DETAILS

Postal Address:

Suburb:	State:	Postcode:
---------	--------	-----------

Club:	Mobile:
-------	---------

Email:

Special Dietary Requirements (please tick box in front or make comment):

☐ Diabetes ☐ Coeliac ☐ Gluten Free ☐ Vegetarian Other _____

CAR DETAILS

REGISTRATION NUMBER

☐ 100	☐ 100S	☐ 100/6	☐ 3000 MKI
☐ 3000 MKII	☐ 3000 MKIII	☐ SPRITE	☐ MODIFIED

OTHER _____



THE AUSTIN-HEALEY 2023 NATIONAL RALLY

TUESDAY 2 MAY – FRIDAY 5 MAY 2023

REGISTRATION FORM

Page 2

National Rally Ticket Price Includes:

- ❖ Welcome party including food and drinks
- ❖ Party Night including dinner and drinks
- ❖ Gala Dinner including dinner, drinks and entertainment
- ❖ Car display show and shine event
- ❖ And more....

Please complete below		\$440		
Number of Adults		@ \$500	Total	\$
Booking of Interest completed	Date:		Amount Paid	\$
			Sub Total	\$
Ticket Price is in Australian Dollars			Total Due	\$

The Ticket Price has been reduced by \$60 to cover the breakfast @ \$20 per person per day due to the Resort accommodation system

The registration form is also available on our website: www.austinhealeynsw.com.au

PAYMENT OF RALLY TICKETS – receipt will be issued for all monies received	
DIRECT DEPOSIT - EFT	Account Name: Austin Healey Owners Club (NSW) Incorporated Westpac Banking Corporation BSB: 032 669 Account Number: 252564 Date amount deposited: ____ / ____ / ____ Please enter your SURNAME RALLY 2023 in reference field to reconcile
CHEQUE / MONEY ORDER	Made payable to Austin Healey Owners Club (NSW) Incorporated Mail to address on Page 1 to the Registrar
Registrations will not be finalised until full payment is received	

*Rally ticket refunds available until 30 days prior to the start of the event.
 Full cancellation fee applies after this due to commitments to the Resort and other venues, the organising committee cannot guarantee a refund.
 A reminder – if cancelling do not forget to contact the Resort to cancel your room and check their refund rules*

REGISTRAR USE DATE RECEIVED ____ / ____ / ____ RECEIPT SENT ____ / ____ / ____ REGISTRATION NO ____

Comments _____

AN EMBARRASSING TRUE STORY (MOSTLY)

By Ronnie Strange

When essential survival provisions were running low at home ie, champagne, cigarettes, cigars, wine, beer and brandy, shopping in France springs to mind. I would check the newsagent to see if any of the Red Top tabloids had an offer going with one of the ferry operators, P&O, Sea France etc. “RETURN FERRY TO FRANCE FOR £5.00”. All one had to do was buy the newspaper over five days, cut out the coupons, choose the travel day, go to the port, hand the coupons and the fiver in at the particular ferry departure gate and up the ramp you’d go onto the ferry.



Apart from the thousands of trucks crossing the Channel the ferry operators made extra money selling duty free goods on board to passengers who just travelled across the Channel and back. Alternatively you could disembark and spend the day driving around northern France or into Belgium before returning to one of the massive supermarkets to shop and then back to the ferry.

The passenger seat in the Austin-Healey was always left at home to allow for the enormous bulk of shopping and because of the weight on board the bodywork and the tyres always came into contact through roundabouts!

Prior to one of these crossings I heard on the radio, a

DJ called Noel Edmonds who was interviewing Don Panoz and they were talking about Panoz cars and Le Mans. This I found interesting and it sort of sunk into my mind. Then incredibly while returning to Dover a month or so later on a ferry, out on the rear deck with my cigar and brandy I spotted this beautiful forty-foot transporter on the lower truck deck with a full-size image of the Panoz LMP1 open top racer painted on the side, returning after their first Le Mans race.



From that moment on, my destiny was fixed. I was going to Le Mans next year.

That first year at Le Mans was 1999 (I enjoyed seven more) The cheap ferry deal at that time was Newhaven to Dieppe. Departure was about six am and via hovercraft.

All was not well. Whilst in the marshalling area waiting to board, the smell of petrol in the vicinity was traced to my car.

There was a gathering of port officials who directed me to a safe place where we examined the pool of petrol under the rear of the car.

Now this is really amazing, one of them pointed to,



**True Story cont'**

no, not into the English Channel but to the maintenance building in the distance, he finished speaking on his Walkie-Talkie and said to go there, ask for John and show him the problem.

A team of three engineers checked all the fuel connections which were not leaking then decided the fuel tank had to come out.

The petrol was poured into a drum and the tank's underneath was examined and it didn't take a genius to see the problem. Severe rust and a hole. They cleaned the area and painted on some magic gunk, prepared a sheet of some magic material, laid that down and painted on some other magic gunk, stood back and admired their work.

Will that work? I asked. "Of course, That's how we keep the ferries afloat" His name wasn't really John and he didn't really say that; honest!

Luckily for me that morning there were no ferries that needed to be patched to stop them from sinking, so the engineers were able to concentrate on patching my car.

A "thank you" was all that was required. That's what you call good customer service.

I was now allowed off the naughty chair and back to the marshalling area and authorised to board a later crossing, but with a car with such a dangerous reputation the port officials were all over it looking for petrol leaks. Everyone else from the marshalling area were now boarding, but I then had to drive around in small circles being closely watched for any sign of leaks.

As you all know about every two years, one of the carburettor floats on your Austin-Healey will stick and petrol will be pumped out through the overflow onto the ground.

That's exactly what happened, it happened right there, right then, right in front of the port officials.

Again as you will all know a few taps with a spanner will "fix" it and they reluctantly agreed to allow me to load this lethal piece of cargo on to their vessel and said it will be at the rear of the ship and if there's a problem they'll shove it into the English Channel. Not sure if they were serious or joking.

In the marshalling area (the later one) I was surrounded by chaps from their Ferraris, Astons, Jaguars, Bentleys etc. and some lesser sports cars, some starting with "M", who were all allowed to board without hassle because they didn't leak petrol, but they all took an interest in the event on the dock before boarding and said hello later at the bar after identifying me as the bloke from the Austin-Healey because of my dirty fingers and soiled clothing.

The run south from Dieppe was finally enjoyable and as planned. However, stopping for coffee, cigar and petrol was again going to turn into another drama. An Austin-Healey from Northern Europe somewhere was stranded at the service station and couldn't be started. The Viking type driver approached me and indicated that he needed jump leads. I had none so he purchased some from the service station and asked me if he could connect my battery to his? ALARM, ALARM, ALARM.

The recent fuel leak in my car had impregnated the tar, pitch rustproofing stuff below the boot and a distinct smell of petrol fumes was present. The last thing we needed was a spark!

Not being linguistically competent to explain my fear to this fellow Austin-Healey bloke, I agreed to help then walked away with my arms over my head and eyes clamped shut. Then finally the foreign car started up and the spark threat was disconnected.

The biggest explosion ever recorded at a service station in France thankfully didn't happen.

The rest of the trip to Le Mans was un-drama-ess.

THE END

Letter from Ian Richter

Patrick, good evening.

Receiving the Flat Chat Newsletter this week spurred me on to forward the below. It's a piece of fluff, a page filler only and sadly no reference to Austin-Healeys. I pulled it together after reading some references in "The British Motor Industry 1896-1939 - A Social and Economic History", it's a hard dry but interesting read. The funniest and best part of the book is the handwritten inscription, "To Stuart with all my love on our 16th Wedding Anniversary". I am curious if the relationship lasted, the book's a killer.

Regards

Ian Richter

The name Eugene Beauharnais Carless, I would hazard a guess, means absolutely nothing to all, except the quirky few who have an obscure knowledge of the birth of the British motor industry.

Petrol as a product has been around since the mid-1800s, and if you thought this common noun, petrol, was derived from the abbreviated petroleum, you would be correct. However that's not why petrol became part of our vernacular across Australia and the UK and was never used in America. I will explain.

Petroleum, Latin for "rock oil", has a history of use dating back about 4,000 years. It has been used in the form of tar or pitch on the walls of Babylon. The Chinese were the first to record the use of petroleum as a fuel as early as the fourth century BC. The Persians and Spanish had a go at distillation and produced flammable material for war, and it popped up in Europe around the 12th century. There are plenty of references throughout time on how petroleum was used, exploited and distilled. Race forward to the mid-1800s when Queen Victoria reigned across the British Empire and so entered Eugene Carless.

Eugene Carless was a self-taught chemist who became bankrupt off the back of an unsuccessful invention of artificial leather in 1855. Down, but not to be beaten, he looked forward to the next big thing, and that was Petroleum.

Carless didn't invent the petroleum distillation process, but he certainly saw the opportunity and knew how to stand on the shoulders of others, so he set up shop in Hackney Wick, London, and in 1859 established the Hope Chemical Works.



Hope Chemicals distilled imported crude oil from America's new oil wells along with refining local coal tar and shales, producing oils, solvents and gases to feed the needs of industrialisation across the UK, and he was very successful.

Petrol cont'

The list of products produced by Carless was extensive, most highly flammable and all toxic. There was one product that was marketed as a solvent, trade named "Carless Petrol", ideal for dissolving the glue off nits, which the female louse uses to stick the nit to hair. One shudders to think of the possible outcomes of an urchin child of the Victorian era being doused in petrol to remove nits, keeping warm by the open fire. I also note with interest that the UK introduced the Petroleum Act of 1862 to control and reduce the number of fires from petroleum products, which was apparently getting out of hand.

By 1870 the wheels of Carless' fortune started to wobble. Carless and his then-business partner, Blagdon, dissolved the company. Pressing on, Carless formed a new firm with George Capel, the Carless, Capel, Co., of Hope Chemical Works. In 1872 John Leonard joined Capel as a partner. Carless was cast out of his company, but was retained by the new partners as the manager of its works. The company name was retained, Carless, Capel and now Leonard Co, Hope Chemical Works.

Unfortunately for Carless, by 1873, he was again bankrupt and no longer played a role in the Hope Chemical Works. The company, now trading as Carless, Capel and Leonard, continued in the refining business, and the popularity of the solvent Carless created "Petrol" continued.

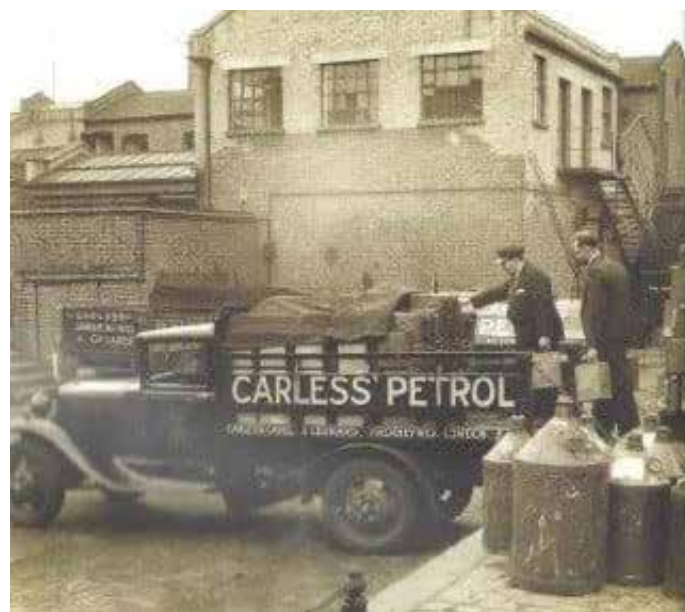


Stay with me, we are almost there.

The new partner of Carless, Capel and Leonard, John Leonard had a mate, Frederick Simms, who was firm friends with Gottlieb Daimler, yes, the pioneer

of internal-combustion engines. Simms purchased the rights for the use and manufacture of Daimler's high-speed petrol engine in the British Empire in 1889. They were first used in motor launches, but soon paved the way for the start-up of the British motor industry. It was at this time that a suitable flammable fuel was sought in the UK for these engines. It needed to be readily obtainable and relatively inexpensive. That's where the nit solvent comes in. Carless "Petrol" was found to be the answer.

Identifying a marketing strategy to promote Petrol's big opportunity, Carless, Capel and Leonard Co applied for a trade name registration to distinguish the product from other motor spirits. So popular was "Petrol" across the UK, the court ruled that it had passed into common parlance and could not be registered or protected.



Carless, Capel and Leonard Co continued to market petrol, firmly linking the firm with the motor car and supplying their new fuel to "Autocarists" for the Emancipation Run to Brighton, UK, in 1896 to celebrate the repeal of the red flag law. (The Emancipation Run and the red flag law is another worthy story for another time) Simms and Leonard were both also founding members of the Automobile Club, later the R.A.C.

At the turn of the Twentieth Century, Carless Petrol was still virtually the only British source of highly refined motor spirit, and by 1906 the firm had 1,300 agents throughout the UK. In London, Petrol was

Cont' next page

available at the Horse and Groom public house in Wimbledon and The Institute of Chauffeurs at Westminster, to name a couple. Across the country, the list of agents was extensive, including 28 inns and hotels, 60 ironmongers, 87 cycle agents, chemists, and village storekeepers were many. Carless Petrol was marketed in two-gallon cans with round necks painted blue and labelled "Carless Petrol". Early vehicles would strap a spare petrol can to the running board of the vehicle, and as Carless, Capel and Leonard Co remarked, offering free advertisement as they motored about the country.

Poor Eugene Carless, cast from the company he founded, was the creator of the solvent called Petrol.

The product was so popular that the term became ingrained in the vernacular across the British Empire, and that's why we say petrol and not gasoline in Australia.

Carless's name has survived, unlike the names of his partners. The Hope Chemical Works was broken up in the 1970s and changed hands a couple of times. It was eventually taken over by an Anglo-German petrochemical firm, rebranded and is known as Haltermann Carless.

Eugene died in 1895 in a town called Rye, he was 80 and penniless.



Only in America?

What looks to me to be a 1954 Cadillac Fleetwood pulled up alongside an Austin-Healey 3000 Mk1.

What could be more different? However it's heartening that the owners share so much between them.



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Contact: Vince Cessario AHOC Member

info@platinumsash.com.au
13 Wilham Street - Artarmon NSW 2054

Surprise Package

Thank you to Richard Horwood for sending the below photos of the dismantling of a genuine 100 engine by himself and Neville Stirton.

Richard recently bought the engine in Queensland as a surprise packet. Externally it looked as if it had

seen better days, but what was inside was a bit of a mystery.

Thankfully the engine gods were smiling down on the exercise and while it does need rebuilding, it is serviceable



**As the engine arrived on a stand.
Looking a bit worse for wear.**



What will removing the cylinder head reveal?



**With the cylinder head removed
it was starting to look good.**



**With the sump removed the oil
pump looked good good with all
the internals surprisingly clean.**

Surprise Package Cont'



Close inspection reveals that the crank has been balanced and has standard journals. Yet to be crack tested



The bore is 90thou over, but in excellent condition. New Holden 179 pistons.



Crank out on its way out. It will need new big ends and mains.



Camshaft ready to be measured for lift etc.



The cylinder head will need some work.



Disaster afoot – broken valve. What other sinister hidden mysteries await?

Gidget the 100 Arrives in the East

Thanks to Harley Boggis

Thank you to Harley Boggis for the below photos that were taken at the finish of the Perth to Sydney Marathon on 6th November at Warwick Farm. There were two Austin-Healeys there - Ashton Roskill's 100 competing and Harley's BJ8 in the carpark.

Harley says he was invited to join some RAC members for lunch at the William Inglis Hotel prior to

greeting the Marathon cars as they finished. A pleasant lunch was followed by a lot of smiling faces, there to see the cars at the finish line.

Ashton Roskill successfully completed the event in his Austin-Healey 100 "Gidget" with Navigator Nick Wade.



**Gidget the AH 100 at the Warwick Farm Finish line.
Ashton Roskill (Driver), Nick Wade (Navigator)**

**Gidget with L-R Peter Eppel (RAC),
Nick Wade (Navigator), Caroline
Roskill, Ashton Roskill (Driver)**

**Harley's BJ8 in fine company at Warwick Farm
carpark with RAC group. Rolls-Royce, Bentley,
four Jaguars and two Citroens.**



Thank you from Geoff Golding

27 Rochester Drive

Bundanoon 2578

17/10/2022

Hello 'Austin Healey Mates'

What a lovely surprise to arrive home after a week in Vincent's Hospital, to receive from Pam Ross a note regarding my now regular "Pit Stops". At the moment; they are far too regular. We are not too sure if the problem for all the stops are as a result of poor quality parts, the wrong oil (red wine) or some other issue.

The problem seems to be from a virus that is attacking my immune system and causing it to not do its job properly; as a result I have no balance and cannot walk without a stick and regularly fall over to the point I now have a Master's Degree in that particular skill. My ability to write has degenerated to the point I have given up hence this note is type written.

All this of course means "Lady" our Healey, is sitting in "The Shed" gathering dust and not being used in the appropriate style "to which she has become accustomed over almost 20 years of ownership"all us blokes know how "Gals" like to be kept in a particular style; We trust "Lady" will forgive her long period of hibernation!

As of last week when discharged from St Vincent's, I have two more appointments with specialists which I think will see me having more of the hospitality of "The Darlington Hilton"

Once again many thanks for the thoughts and wishes

Regards




FOR SALE



FOR SALE



FOR SALE

Two boxes of overdrive parts. Are you looking for overdrive parts? Make an offer.

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Richard Horwood - 0408 233 592

Free to a Good Home

To suit 3000 BT7 Mk1
Roll bar
Soft tonneau
Half hard tonneau.
Will be discarded if no one wants them.
Tim Scarr 0412 360 436



Your Last Page



New Austin-Healeys and MGAs at Abingdon.



Princess Grace of Monaco and her 3000.



Three Austin-Healeys in various states of disrepair. The top two are both 100s with the top right having been on the Isle of Arran for close on to 45 years. The 3000 Mk1 below could probably do with more than a cut and polish.



Monthly Meetings

**We meet on the first Thursday of the month at Strathfield Golf Club
Weeroona Rd, Strathfield. Starting at 7.30pm or enjoy dinner from 5.30pm**